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Trust among Recent Immigrants in Canada: Levels, Roots and Implications for Immigrant Integration

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Abstract

Generalized trust promotes social interactions and may well be a crucial component of immigrant integration. Recent immigrants in particular are likely to be viewed by themselves and others as "outsiders" who are unfamiliar with the expectations and norms that structure day-to-day social interactions in the host country. This study relies on a unique combination of three sources of data all derived from *World Values Surveys* to examine levels of trust, and its sources, among newcomers in one country with a large immigrant population, Canada. The evidence indicates that recent immigrants to Canada make a clear distinction between trust in other people in general, and trust in Canadians in particular: the former is grounded in pre-migration cultural influences, while the latter is grounded in immigrants' experiences in the new host country. Moreover, the evidence suggests trust in Canadians is a crucial component of immigrant integration.

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Introduction

Generalized trust, a predisposition toward engagement and cooperation with others (Stolle 2002), promotes social interactions. The norms of reciprocity underpinning generalized trust allow people to engage in social, economic, and political exchanges with the belief that other members of society will treat them with respect and honesty (Putnam 1993). A number of studies also highlight the relationship between greater generalized trust and such other positive attitudes and behaviours as greater satisfaction with democracy and greater compliance in paying taxes (Scholz and Lubell 1998; Uslaner 2002; Zmerli and Newton 2008).

Generalized trust is arguably even more important in countries with large foreign-born populations, where it may well be a crucial component of immigrant integration. Recent immigrants in particular are likely to be viewed by themselves and others as "outsiders" who are unfamiliar with the expectations and norms that structure day-to-day social interactions in the host country. This "outsider" status could have significant consequences for immigrants' levels of generalized trust and, consequently, for their overall integration in the host country. It might be more difficult to trust others in a context where one knows so few people. Moreover, a number of studies indicate that generalized trust is related to individuals' perceived state of health (Helliwell 2003) and overall life satisfaction (Lindstrom and Mohseni 2009; Rostila 2007). There is no reason to think that immigrants are any different from the general population when it comes to these kinds of relationships. From this perspective, generalized trust among immigrants is not only a key element of their integration, but also potentially an expression of their resilience in the face of cultural, social, economic, and political challenges associated with migration.

A number of studies on the topic have been published over the last few years, in both European (Nannestad et al., 2014; Dinesen, 2013; Dinesen, 2012a, 2012b; Dinesen and Hooghe, 2010) and American contexts (Uslaner, 2008; Rice and Feldman, 1997). Our study focuses on Canada, a country sometimes seen as "exceptional" with respect to immigration and immigrant integration (Bloemraad, 2012). The limited evidence concerning generalized trust among immigrants seems to support this view. Soroka and his colleagues (2007) find that immigrants are more trustful than the Canadian-born population, even after taking into account average levels of trust in immigrants' country of origin. This finding contrasts sharply with evidence from Europe, where immigrants appear to be generally more trustful than the population in their country of origin, but less trustful than the population in the host country (Nannestad et al., 2014; Dinesen, 2013; Dinesen, 2012a, 2012b; Dinesen and Hooghe, 2010). This study examines the Canadian case to verify whether it really is unique. It provides an opportunity to test Canada's reputation of achievement with regards to this facet of immigrant integration, and reflects on what might explain such "Canadian exceptionalism".

In line with previous studies on the topic, this article investigates not only levels of generalized trust among recent immigrants in Canada, but also the cultural and institutional correlates of trust. This study departs, however, from most existing studies by investigating two potentially different forms of trust. It focuses not only on generalized trust, but also a more specific form of trust (see Soroka et al. 2007), namely trust in the host (Canadian) population. Looking specifically at immigrants who have been living in Canada for a decade or less, this study addresses three questions: First, how much trust do recent immigrants exhibit in comparison to other Canadians? Second, what factors structure immigrants' trust? And third, just how important is trust

to immigrant integration? The study relies on a unique combination of three sources of data all derived from *World Values Surveys*: 1) 2000 and 2006 Canadian components, 2) special sub-samples of recent Canadian immigrants in 2000 and 2006, and 3) corresponding national components for immigrants' countries of origin.

The study proceeds as follows. First, we review the literature on trust among immigrants, distinguishing not only between broad perspectives on the sources of immigrant trust, but also between different forms of trust. After outlining the research design and data, we then analyze differences between recent immigrants and the Canadian-born population with respect to levels of trust, and attempt to account for those differences. Next, we direct our attention to the sources of trust among recent immigrants, and its relation to other dimensions of immigrant integration. We conclude by discussing the contribution of this study to our understanding of immigrant trust within host societies.

The Origins of Trust among Immigrants: Cultural and Institutional Influences

Research on immigrant attitudes often distinguishes between pre-migration and post-migration factors. A recent study by White, Bilodeau, and Nevitte (2015), for example, shows the importance of both sets of factors when it comes to explaining recent immigrants' support for the Canadian political community. There are at least two ways to think about the origins of generalized trust, the cultural perspective and the institutional perspective, which correspond very well to this pre/post-migration distinction.

First, trust can be viewed as norm-driven, representing a cultural orientation (Uslaner 2002). From this vantage point, trust is something that develops early in life, and is inherited through socialization (Nannestad 2008, 415) like other norms, values, and beliefs (see Sears 1990). Building on this cultural perspective, one would expect that the systematic differences in levels of generalized trust across countries (Dehley and Newton 2005; Inglehart 1997) persists among immigrants in the host country.

Studies in Europe (Dinesen and Hooge 2010; Dinesen 2013), the United States (Rice and Feldman 1997; Uslaner 2008), and Canada (Soroka et al. 2007) find that immigrants' generalized trust correlates with levels of trust within their country of origin. Accordingly, we expect to observe pre-migration cultural influences on Canadian immigrants' levels of trust; that is, we anticipate immigrants from countries with lower average levels of trust to be less likely to express trust in others, and those from countries with higher levels of trust to be more likely to express trust in others.

A second perspective on trust, however, sees it as grounded in the institutional structure of a society and the day-to-day experiences of individuals. From the institutional perspective, trust varies with societal conditions and relates to individuals' social experiences (Stolle 2002, 408). There is empirical support for this perspective on trust among immigrants. Looking at levels of generalized trust of immigrants from 90 countries settling in 18 Western European countries, Dinesen (2013) observes that even though immigrants' trust is rooted in the level of trust in their country of origin, it is also structured by the level of corruption in the host country, with higher levels of corruption associated with lower levels of trust among immigrants. Other studies lend further support for the institutional perspective on trust among immigrants (see Dinesen, 2012a;

Nannestad et al. 2014).

These earlier studies suggest a link between the performance of national institutions and immigrants' level of trust. The institutional perspective on trust among immigrants, however, can also be examined from the vantage point of the unique social and economic challenges faced by newcomers in the host country and their impacts on immigrants' trust in other people. In a study of immigrants in Denmark, Dinesen (2012b) finds that although trust is transmitted across generations among both immigrants and native-born Danes, perceived institutional fairness also structures immigrants' levels of trust in others. Consistent with Dinesen's findings, additional studies indicate that perceived discrimination or mistreatment in the host country can negatively affect immigrants' relationships with political institutions of the host country (Michelson 2003; Maxwell 2010) or jeopardize their identification with the host country (Ono 2002; Berry et al. 2006; Verkuyten and Yildiz 2007).

Along a similar line of reasoning, we know that economic integration is frequently a challenge for immigrants, and the evidence suggests it is increasingly difficult for newcomers in Canada (Picot 2008; Kustec 2012). Immigrants' economic expectations and their changing personal financial well-being might have important implications for trust. Maxwell (2010) reports that immigrants who are more satisfied with the economy in the host country are also more inclined to express satisfaction with the government. Similarly, White et al. (2015) find that newcomers whose economic situations improve with immigration express more positive feelings toward Canada than newcomers whose economic situations deteriorate. It is not unreasonable to presume that immigrants who struggle economically might be more likely than other immigrants to distrust other people. Accordingly, we expect immigrants who experience mistreatment or who struggle to integrate economically to be less trustful.

As previous research demonstrates, the cultural and institutional perspectives on trust are not mutually exclusive, and immigrants' trust seems to relate to both the cultural influences of the country of origin and new experiences in the host country. Moreover, when studying the origins of trust among immigrants, research must also take into account different forms of trust.

Different Forms of Trust among Immigrants: Generalized and Specific Trust

Scholars studying social trust make the distinction between "generalized trust" and "specific" (Soroka et al. 2007) or "particularized" trust (Nannestad 2008). This distinction usually presupposes that generalized trust extends to people not known personally, whereas specific trust targets more pointed situations or people. For instance, when discussing and measuring specific trust, Soroka et al. (2007) rely on questions in which people are asked to assess the likelihood that their lost wallet would be returned to them under a particular set of circumstances.

Generalized trust concerns people in general, not trust in a particular group of people. When studying immigrants, this offers some advantages, but it does not tell us much about trust directed specifically towards people in the host country – the context in which immigrants live. There are good reasons to think that these are two different forms of trust when it comes to immigrants. In the minds of native-born citizens, "people in general" and "Canadians" may well be synonymous. However, immigrants with prior experiences in a completely different setting might make a

distinction between the two: it is quite possible that they have earlier experiences in mind when they think about how much trust they place in "people in general," but a narrower set of interactions in mind when they think about "Canadians." Learning more about immigrants' trust in people in the host national context might reveal a different picture of the roots of trust among immigrants. Indeed, Soroka et al.'s (2007) Canadian study indicates that the origins of generalized and specific trust are quite distinct; the former is grounded in cultural influences, while the latter is grounded in contextual experiences. Considering that most studies on immigrants' trust have focused only on generalized trust, this study proposes to examine both forms of trust. The remainder of this study assesses the relevance of the cultural and institutional perspectives on both of these forms of trust among recent immigrants in Canada.

Research Design and Data

The analysis relies on data collected for the 2000 and 2006 Canadian components of *World Value Survey* (WVS), as well as data from the 2000 and 2006 *New Immigrant Survey* (NIS) conducted as part of the Canadian of the WVS. The NIS sample includes responses from 1,058 face-to-face interviews conducted in greater Montreal, Toronto and Vancouver with immigrants who have lived in Canada for a decade or less.[1] Our analysis of the WVS sample is restricted to 579 Canadian-born citizens residing largely in Montreal, Toronto, and Vancouver.[2]

We rely on the standard survey question used in most studies of generalized trust. Respondents to the WVS and NIS were asked: "Generally speaking, would you say that most people can be trusted or that you can't be too careful in dealing with people?" The generalized trust scores in the country of origin for 856 immigrants in the NIS sample were obtained from the earlier waves of the *World Values Survey* using the same question.

Respondents to the 2006 WVS and NIS were asked: "I 'd like to ask you how much you trust people from various groups. Could you tell me for each whether you trust people from this group completely, somewhat, not very much or not at all?" We focus on respondents' trust in "Canadians."[3] Because there is only modest variation in the responses to this question, responses

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[1] We have excluded from the analyses 393 immigrants from the WVS because the WVS questionnaire did not allow us to identify their specific country of origin. These include a small number of immigrants who have also been in Canada for ten years or less.

[2] A precise match of the geographic locations of WVS respondents with those of NIS respondents is not possible. We restrict the WVS sample to respondents in Quebec, Ontario, and British Columbia who resided in cities with populations of more than 500,000. All of the British Columbia respondents in this restricted sample lived in Greater Vancouver; based of the size of cities with population of more than 500,000 people in Quebec and Ontario, we estimate that more than 85 percent of respondents in these two provinces lived in Greater Montreal and Toronto.

[3] Responses were elicited for a list of 10 groups. The results of a factor analysis of the NIS responses to this battery of questions reveal that only two items have strong loadings on the first factor: "Canadians" and "French Canadians" (See Appendix A). Neither of these items have strong loadings on any other factor (indeed, none of the other loadings generated eigenvalues above the standard 1.0 cut-off). "French Canadians", of course, is likely to hold different meaning in Montreal, where the overwhelming majority of the population is French-speaking, than in Toronto or Vancouver. As it turns out, levels of trust in "Canadians" and "French Canadians" are very

are divided in two groups: (1) those who say they trust Canadians "completely" or "somewhat" are compared to (2) those who say they trust Canadians "not very much" or "not at all".[4] In the sections that follow, we investigate both generalized trust and trust in Canadians.

Trust among Recent Immigrants in Canada

Generalized Trust

The data indicate that recent immigrants have higher levels of generalized trust than the Canadian-born population. While about 48% of recent immigrants indicate that "most people can be trusted", this proportion is only 38% among the Canadian-born population.[5] At first glance, this might come as a surprise given that recent immigrants know relatively few people in the host country. These findings are also stand in sharp contrast to those of other studies in the European context, which show that immigrants generally tend to express weaker trust than the local population (Nannestad et al., 2014; Dinesen, 2013; Dinesen, 2012a, 2012b; Dinesen and Hooghe, 2010), but they are consistent with Soroka et al. (2007) who also observe that immigrants in Canada are more trustful than the local population. What, then, explains the distinctly higher level of trust among immigrants in Canada?

We consider two possibilities. First, as indicated by Delhy and Newton (2005) and Inglehart (1997), levels of generalized trust vary significantly across countries. It is possible that immigrants in our sample come largely from countries with higher levels of generalized trust, and that they have transposed this generalized trust onto Canadian society. Our data partially support that explanation, as immigrants' levels of generalized trust are related to levels of generalized trust in the countries from which they come. The correlation between immigrants' individual trust score in Canada and that in their country of origin is .28 (significant at $p < .001$). These initial findings suggest that immigrants' levels of generalized trust may indeed be grounded in pre-migration cultural influences. Second, the socio-economic profile of immigrants could also account for their higher levels of generalized trust than the Canadian-born population. More specifically, we know that recent immigrants tend to be better educated than the rest of the Canadian population, in part because Canada's immigrant selection policy favours highly educated applicants. In our sample, a much larger proportion of recent immigrants than other Canadians possess university degrees (62% versus 21%, respectively).

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closely related among Montreal respondents (correlation = .87) but less so among people in Toronto (.67) and Vancouver (.62). Consequently, we decided to focus only on trust in "Canadians." The wording of the question was different in 2000; we therefore do not use it for this part of the analysis.

[4] For the NIS sample, the original distribution is the following: "Trust completely" (8.6%), "trust somewhat" (76.1%), "do not trust very much" (14.3%), "do not trust at all" (1.0%). For the analyses that follow, we also analyzed other transformations of the variable, but they resulted in broadly similar conclusions as those reached using the current transformation. Those alternative models are not presented.

[5] This proportion is for the Canadian-born population residing largely in Montreal, Toronto, and Vancouver. Additional analyses (not presented here, but available from the authors upon request) indicate that the results are not significantly different when we broaden the analyses to the entire Canadian-born sample. This holds for the entire set of analyses presented in this study.

The analysis presented in Table 1 examines whether education and other socio-economic factors (age, unemployment status, financial satisfaction, sex, visible minority status, and province of residence) can explain the gap in generalized trust between recent immigrants and the Canadian-born population. The analysis proceeds in two steps. In Model 1, only two independent variables are incorporated (whether or not the respondent is a recent immigrant (1-0), and the mean level of generalized trust of the population in the respondent's country of birth).[6] In Model 2, we introduce all of the socio-economic variables mentioned above. The binary dependent variable indicates whether the respondent expresses generalized trust or not.

INSERT TABLE 1 HERE

The analysis in Model 1 corroborates the descriptive findings. First, recent immigrants appear more trustful than the Canadian-born population, even after controlling for the average level of trust expressed by people in their countries of origin. The logit coefficients presented in this and subsequent models are easier to interpret when they are converted to predicted probabilities, holding the values of all other variables in the models constant at their means. These predicted probabilities indicate that while 52% of recent immigrants express the view that most people can be trusted, the proportion is only 37% among the Canadian-born population. Nevertheless, above and beyond this "recent immigrant effect", the analysis indicates that the higher the level of generalized trust in the country of origin, the greater the propensity of recent immigrants to express the view that most people can be trusted. Our estimates indicate that only 38% of immigrants express the view that most people can be trusted if they come from a country where only two in ten people express that view. This proportion rises to 69% when six in ten people in an immigrant's country of origin express trust.

The analysis in Model 2 indicates that, when controlling for education and other socio-demographic variables, the "country of origin" effect is of a similar magnitude as in Model 1. The "recent immigrant" effect is only marginally reduced: there is now a 13-point gap between recent immigrants and the Canadian-born population in the predicted probability of expressing trust in people. Our analyses therefore indicate that neither the origins nor the higher education levels of immigrants in Canada account for these higher levels of generalized trust.

Trust in Canadians

The data do not indicate any difference between recent immigrants and other Canadians when it comes to trust in Canadians. Recent immigrants and other Canadians are equally likely (85% and 84%, respectively) to say they "completely" or "somewhat" trust Canadians.[7] Moreover,

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[6] We are primarily concerned with the impact of early socialization experiences of immigrants. Accordingly, all foreign-born respondents are assigned the mean score from earliest WVS survey available for their country of origin (starting from 1981). Canadian-born respondents are assigned the mean score for the Canadian population score for 2000 or 2006, corresponding to their year of interview. We have not weighted these data.

[7] An additional question we explored is why generalized trust is relatively lower among the Canadian-born population, when there is essentially no difference between recent immigrants and those born in Canada with respect to trust in Canadians. A possibility we considered is that negative attitudes toward outgroups might lower Canadian-born respondents' generalized trust.

unlike generalized trust, immigrants' trust in Canadians is not correlated with average levels of generalized trust within immigrants' respective countries of origin.[8] The correlation is only .09 and is not statistically significant. Indeed, generalized trust and trust in Canadians appear to be distinct attitudinal orientations in the minds of recent immigrants and the Canadian-born population: the correlation between measures of these two orientations is quite modest (Cramer's V = .21 for recent immigrants, and .34 for the Canadian-born population).

Cultural and Institutional Perspectives and Trust among Recent Immigrants

To further investigate the origins of trust among immigrants, we focus our analyses solely on recent immigrants. Moreover, we limit our analyses to the 2006 NIS because many of the indicators are not available in the 2000 NIS. Our post-migration experiences indicators include measures of whether immigrants believe they have been treated worse than other Canadians, either by the Canadian government or by Canadians in general. Moreover, we include a measure of whether immigrants are members of groups that are generally more likely than others to experience discrimination. Given that this study focuses on Canada, we rely here on the official Statistics Canada's definition of "visible minority", which is a "person other than Aboriginal peoples, who are non- Caucasian in race or non-white in colour." This consists of the following groups: Chinese, South Asian, Black, Arab, West Asian, Filipino, Southeast Asian, Latin American, Japanese and Korean. Our economic indicators are measures of "unemployment" and "change in economic situation with migration."

We also include variables measuring whether immigrants have acquired Canadian citizenship, and their length of residence (ranging from 1 to 10 years). If the status of being an "outsider" to Canada is indeed associated with distrust, then acquiring citizenship of the host country might serve as an important symbolic experience that strengthens immigrants' bonds with their fellow citizens. For that reason, we expect to observe greater levels of trust among immigrants who have acquired Canadian citizenship, especially with regards to trust in Canadians. The potential effects of length of residence are harder to anticipate. Conceivably, trust might grow stronger with length of residence, as immigrants become more familiar with the norms of the host country. But it is also possible, as Dinesen and Hooghe (2010) have observed, that as they become acculturated immigrants' levels of trust converge with the Canadian average. Given that recent immigrants are, on average, more trustful that the Canadian-born population, this line of reasoning suggests immigrant trust might actually decline with length of residence.

The final set of variables included in the analysis is to assess the effects of pre-migration cultural influences. First, we include our indicator of the level of generalized trust in immigrants' countries of origin. Second, we incorporate a variable that measures immigrants' satisfaction with their economic situation prior to migration. If immigrants' level of generalized trust is grounded in the cultural environment in which they were socialized, it is also possible that it is influenced by the economic conditions they experienced in their countries of origin.

We investigated this possibility by examining whether controlling for trust in recent immigrants and trust in people from ethnic groups other than one's own reduces the gap in generalized trust between recent immigrants and the Canadian born population. It does not.

[8] There was no evidence of a gap between recent immigrants and the Canadian-born population, even when we control for socio-economic factors. Thus, we did not proceed with further analysis.

INSERT TABLE 2 HERE

Several important findings can be observed in the multivariate results presented in Table 2. First, the analyses substantiate the view that pre-migration cultural influences matter. The higher the level of generalized trust in the country of origin, the more likely immigrants are to express the view that "most people can be trusted". No such finding is observed with respect to immigrants' trust in Canadians. We also find a significant effect for immigrants' pre-migration personal economic conditions. Predicted probabilities indicate that while 70% of immigrants who report full satisfaction with their economic situation in the country of origin believe "most people can be trusted", the proportion is only 26% among immigrants who were completely dissatisfied with their economic situation in the country of origin.

The impact of Canadian experiences in shaping immigrants' levels of trust depends on whether we refer to trust in people in general, or trust in Canadians more specifically. There is little evidence to suggest that immigrants' levels of generalized trust are affected by their experiences in Canada. Whether or not immigrants' report being treated worse than other Canadians – either by the government or by the Canadian people – has no bearing on their levels of generalized trust. By the same token, whether or not they are members of a visible minority group has no discernible impact either. Moreover, generalized trust does not appear to vary with immigrants' length of residence, nor is acquiring citizenship associated with the likelihood of expressing trust in people in general. The only evidence pointing to the influence of the Canadian experience relates to economic satisfaction: Immigrants who experience an improvement in their economic situation with migration appear more likely than other immigrants to express the view that "most people can be trusted."

However, social experiences in Canada are important when it comes to making sense of immigrants' levels of trust in Canadians. Predicted probabilities indicate that while only 68% of immigrants who report being treated worse than other Canadians by the government express trust in Canadians, this proportion is significantly higher (89%) among immigrants who do not report any mistreatment. Observational data like these always pose challenges when it comes to discerning the causal impact of independent variables.[9] As such, the magnitude of the effect of perceived mistreatment should be interpreted with some caution, as it is possible that some recent immigrants are more likely to perceive mistreatment by the government because of their distrust of Canadians, thereby inflating the apparent causal effect of perceived mistreatment. Nevertheless, if endogeneity were a serious concern, we would expect perceptions of mistreatment by other Canadians to be more problematic than mistreatment by the state, because the dependent variable

[9] In our study, that challenge is further complicated by the fact that our dependent variables and many of our independent variables are dichotomous, and there is no generally accepted statistical procedure for dealing with endogeneity under these kinds of conditions (Angrist, 2001). One frequently used approach is to instrument the endogenous variables in a two-stage multivariate model. Quite aside from the absence of any commonly accepted strategy for dealing with both dichotomous dependent variables and dichotomous endogenous variables, we were unable to identify suitable exogenous variables to use as instruments. As such, we interpret the multivariate results with caution, noting instances where reciprocal causation and biased results are possibilities.

measures trust in *Canadians* rather than trust in the government. It turns out that perceived mistreatment by other Canadians has no discernible impact on levels of trust.[10] Moreover, neither being a member of a visible minority group, nor economic experiences in Canada, has any effect on trust in Canadians.

Acquiring Canadian citizenship and residing in Canada for a longer period are significantly related to immigrants' trust in Canadians. Immigrants who have acquired Canadian citizenship are substantially more likely to express trust in Canadians than immigrants who have not, an estimated difference of fourteen points (94% vs. 80%). Becoming a citizen seems to be a pivotal event that helps boost immigrants' trust in their fellow Canadian citizens. Although the reverse causal relationship is conceivable – that is, immigrants who trust Canadians might be more likely to acquire citizenship – it seems doubtful that this accounts for very much of the relationship between citizenship and trust. The most significant determinants of citizenship acquisition for immigrants in Canada are economic considerations (Picot and Hou, 2011).

The evidence, however, also points to an erosion of trust in Canadians the longer immigrants reside in the country.[11] The model predicts that 93% of immigrants will express trust in Canadians during their first year in the country. However, this trust erodes by an estimated 2.4% per year to 69% after a decade in the country – an average level substantially lower than that of the rest of the population. This particular finding is troubling. Although we raised the possibility that immigrant trust could decline with length of residence, the idea was that as immigrants acculturated, their average level of trust would converge with that of the local population. What we instead find is such a dramatic decline in trust with each passing year in Canada that newcomers' outlooks *diverge* considerably from those of the local population.

Overall, these findings highlight two important patterns. First, pre-migration cultural influences matter significantly when it comes to immigrants' levels of generalized trust. Second, post-migration experiences (such as mistreatment by the government, citizenship acquisition, and length of residence) matter significantly with respect to immigrants' level of trust in Canadians.[12]

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[10] It is not clear why perceived mistreatment by other Canadians has no significant effect. It may well be the case that asking respondents whether they have been mistreated by other Canadians is too general a question. We also explored the possibility that mistreatment by the government and by other Canadians might be collinear, thereby making it more difficult to assess their independent impacts; it turns out however that there is no collinearity problem between these two variables.

[11] We tested whether the length of residence effects are curvilinear by adding a squared term for length of residence. The coefficient was not significant and there was no improvement in model fit. We also examined interactions between length of residence and our other independent variables; none of these were significant.

[12] Another specification of the model was performed for trust in Canadians, this time including generalized trust as an independent variable. However, because there is probably a reciprocal causal relationship between generalized trust and trust in Canadians we excluded generalized trust from the final model. The results for all other coefficients in this alternative model specification are virtually the same as those presented in Table 2.

Trust and Immigrant Integration: The Role of Generalized Trust vs. Trust in Canadians

Cultural and institutional perspectives are both helpful to understand the origins of trust among recent immigrants in Canada, but their explanatory leverage depends on exactly who are the objects of trust. This raises an additional question: which form of trust is a better indicator of immigrant integration? Previous research indicates that generalized trust fosters democratic values (Inglehart 1997) and is positively associated with individuals' perceived state of health (Helliwell 2003) and their overall life satisfaction (Lindstrom and Mohseni 2009; Rostila 2007). In this final empirical section, we assess whether generalized trust or trust in Canadians is more strongly correlated with six key indicators of integration: 1) levels of confidence in Canadian political institutions, 2) interest in politics, 3) satisfaction with democracy, 4) life satisfaction, 5) level of personal happiness, and 6) subjective evaluation of personal state of health. If trust is a signal of immigrants' resilience in the host country, then we should expect positive correlations between our trust indicators and these six indicators of immigrant integration. We performed OLS regressions for each of these six indicators, first with generalized trust as a predictor, then with trust in Canadians as a predictor, and finally with both trust measures as predictors. Only recent immigrants are included in the analyses.

The results presented in Table 3 tell a relatively straightforward story. Trust in Canadians is a positive and statistically significant correlate for five of the six integration indicators. Hence, recent immigrants who express trust in Canadians also express greater confidence in Canadian political institutions, and they are more interested in politics. Moreover, immigrants who express trust in Canadians exhibit higher levels of life satisfaction and happiness, and they provide more positive assessments of their personal state of health. By way of contrast, generalized trust is not a significant correlate of any of these five indicators. Finally, neither trust in Canadians nor generalized trust is related to recent immigrants' levels of satisfaction with democracy in Canada. The bivariate and multivariate results tell the same story: trust in Canadians is linked to a number of other measures of immigrant integration in the host country, whereas generalized trust is not. Taken together, our findings suggest that post-migration experiences are associated with trust in Canadians, which is in turn related to their political integration and their overall quality of life. This is not to say that generalized trust is unimportant. However, for recent immigrants, trust in Canadians – not people in general – appears to be a central dimension of their integration.

INSERT TABLE 3 HERE

Conclusion

Trust is essential in developing and maintaining common values and goals in Canada and other Western democracies (Putnam 1993; Inglehart 1997). In the case of immigrants, trust is arguably even more important in facilitating their integration to the host country. This study contributes to our understanding of the dynamics of trust among immigrants in three ways.

The first contribution concerns our knowledge about levels of trust among recent immigrants. Recent immigrants in Canada are substantially more likely than the local population to express trust in people in general, a finding that is consistent with other Canadian evidence (Soroka et al. 2007). In the European context, several studies show that immigrants express lower levels of generalized trust than the rest of the population (Nannestad et al., 2014; Dinesen, 2013;

Dinesen, 2012a, 2012b; Dinesen and Hooghe, 2010). In this respect, Canadian immigrants appear to be exceptional.

The second contribution of this study is to advance our understanding of why Canadian immigrants do, or do not, express trust. The results of our study suggest that both the cultural and institutional perspectives are helpful to account for trust among recent immigrants in Canada. Indeed, the evidence presented here is quite consistent with White et al.'s (2015) findings that both early-life pre-migration experiences and day-to-day post-migration experiences structured recent immigrants' relationship with the host political community. The present study, employing the same immigrant survey as White et al. (2015), demonstrates that some of the same structuring factors help better understand the quality of the trust relationship that recent immigrants develop with their new fellow compatriots in Canada.

We find that whether immigrants express trust in other people in general depends on the average level of trust among people in their respective countries of origin. Newcomers thus appear to have developed levels of generalized trust, like through early socialization, which reflect the prevailing norms in the countries from which they come. This conclusion is consistent with prior research on the topic (Dinesen, 2013; Dinesen, 2012a; Dinesen and Hooghe, 2010), and with other studies that emphasize the enduring influence of pre-migration experiences on newcomers' political orientations in the host country (Bilodeau 2014: Bilodeau, McAllister and Kanji 2010; Bilodeau 2008; Bueker 2005).

From a policy perspective, this study suggests that immigrants who arrive with a rich stock of generalized trust are to some extent inoculated against potentially adverse experiences in the host country. Immigrants are quite likely to maintain a positive orientation toward people in general, even if their encounters in the host country are not wholly positive. These immigrants may well show greater resilience in the face of a more difficult integration experience. For those immigrants who arrive with a poor stock of generalized trust, however, the situation is different. These newcomers, our study suggests, begin the integration process at a disadvantage, carrying the weight of distrust in people that they acquired prior to migration.

But post-migration experiences in Canada also play an important role in structuring recent immigrants' levels of trust, suggesting the "institutional" perspective is also helpful in when it comes to understanding trust among immigrants. The impact of these post-migration experiences, however, is most evident in trust in Canadians. Immigrants who feel mistreated by the Canadian government are less likely than other immigrants to express trust in Canadians. Moreover, the act of acquiring Canadian citizenship appears to serve as a critical symbolic event for immigrants, strengthening their relationship with the rest of the community and increasing their level of trust in Canadians. However, whether this citizenship effect depends on the particular kinds of policies in place at the time of naturalization is an open question.[13]

[13] However, just as the effects of citizenship may be different in other national contexts, they may also vary across time in Canada, depending on the policy context. For instance, important restrictive citizenship reforms have been implemented in Canada since the data were collected for this project (see Winter 2014). The effects of citizenship might be different in this new policy context.

The implication is that fostering and nurturing trustful relationships between immigrants and other citizens of the host country may be an important element in improving integration outcomes. Fighting discrimination appears to be a profitable strategy from this perspective. Moreover, encouraging naturalization and supporting immigrants in the naturalization process (Bloemraad 2006), is also a central element in ensuring trust among all members of society, old and new.

The third contribution of this study is to answer the question: which form of trust is most important when it comes to immigrant integration? There is a significant body of research demonstrating the multiple ways in which trust is important for social cohesion and governance. The question is: trust in *whom*? The results are unequivocal: immigrants who express trust in their fellow new compatriots also express greater confidence in Canadian political institutions, are more interested in politics, feel happier and healthier, and more satisfied with their lives. Trust, then, is indeed a key component of a successful integration of newcomers, but that trust appears to be context-specific.

Although this study has advanced our understanding of recent Canadian immigrants' trust within the host society, it has also identified at least two areas where further research is warranted. First, there is the worrisome finding is that trust in Canadians appears to decline during the first decade in the country, even after controlling for many potentially confounding factors. This decline cannot be interpreted as a convergence toward levels of trust among the local population, as Dinesen and Hooghe observed (2010); the gap between immigrants and the Canadian-born population does not shrink with length of residence, it grows. The implication is that trust in Canadians might be relatively fragile, especially when compared to immigrants' generalized trust. And perhaps most importantly, it reinforces the significance of the stock of generalized trust that immigrants carry with them from the country of origin.

This begs the question of what accounts for this seeming decline of trust in Canadians over time. Evidence from several studies indicates that the quality of the relationship with the host society declines as immigrants experience, or perceive, discrimination (Ono 2002; Michelson 2003; Berry et al. 2006; Verkuyten and Yildiz 2007; Maxwell 2010). Although our analyses take into account mistreatment by the government and other Canadians, it is quite possible that our indicators are unable to capture the full extent of recent immigrants' negative experiences in Canada, especially as they relate to the increasingly difficult economic experiences of immigrants over the last decades (Picot 2008; Kustec 2012). Accordingly, accumulated negatives experiences could partly account for the decline in trust in Canadians as length of residence increases.

The second unanswered question that merits greater attention in the future relates to immigrants' higher levels of generalized trust. There appears to be something unique about Canadian immigrants, or about the Canadian context, that explains the high levels of trust among newcomers, but our study is unable to precisely identify its source. One possibility we considered is that immigrants to Canada come from countries with relatively high levels of trust. Indeed, compared to Europe, larger proportions of Canadian immigrants come from China and India (De la Rica et al., 2013; Statistics Canada, 2012), two countries where generalized trust tends to be

relatively high (Delhey and Newton, 2005).[14] Nevertheless, the culture in immigrants' country of origin cannot fully account for the disparity between recent immigrants and the rest of the Canadian population. Our analyses have shown that even after controlling for average levels of trust among people in their respective countries of origin, recent immigrants still appear to be more trustful than the Canadian-born population. Another explanation centres on Canada's highly selective immigration policy that favours highly educated immigrants (Kelley and Trebilcock, 2010, 362). However, even after controlling for substantially higher levels of education in our immigrant sample, immigrants remain more trustful than the Canadian-born population. Finally, yet another potential explanation relates to the length of residence of newcomers. It is quite likely that most immigrants in the European studies cited earlier had lived in their host countries for longer periods than those in our sample of recent immigrants. Although we did not observe any change in levels of generalized trust with length of residence among these newcomers, immigrants' levels of generalized trust may well converge with that of the local population over a longer period of time.

[14] We assessed the impact on the findings of Chinese immigrants, a major source of immigration in Canada, using two alternate specifications of the models presented in this article. First, we incorporated a dummy variable for Chinese immigrants. Second, we excluded Chinese immigrants and focused only on immigrants from other countries. None of the results in these models were substantially different from those presented in this article.

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Appendices

Appendix A. Factor Analysis Results (Specific Trust), NIS 2006

Variable	Rotated First Factor Loading
Trust in:	
…Your family	.10
…Your neighbourhood	.27
…People you know personally	.25
…People you meet for the first time	.28
…Canadians	.79
…French Canadians	.79
…Recent immigrants	.39
…Americans	.28
…People from your own ethnic group	.29
…People from other ethnic groups	.22
Factor Eigenvalue	3.39

Method: principal factors with varimax rotation

Appendix B: Construction of variables

Generalized trust:	1=Most people can be trusted
	0=Can't be too careful when dealing with people
Trust in Canadians	1=Somewhat or fully trust Canadian people in general
	0=Do not trust very much or do not trust Canadians at all
Generalized trust in the country of origin	Based on % in country of origin expressing the view "most people can be trusted" – WVS data. For foreign-born respondents, data are from the earliest year for which WVS data are available in the country of origin. For Canadian-born respondents, data are from the WVS 2000 and 2006.
Economic situation in country of origin	0 to 10 scale indicating immigrants' self-assessment of their economic situation in the country of origin, where 0 means completely dissatisfied and 10 means completely satisfied.
Treated worse by other Canadians	1=Immigrants evaluate having been treated worse than other Canadians by Canadians.
	0=Immigrants evaluate having been treated better or similarly as other Canadians.
Treated worse by government	1=Immigrants evaluate having been treated worse than other Canadians by the government of Canada.
	0=Immigrants evaluate having been treated better or similarly as other Canadians.
Visible minority	1=member of a visible minority group, as defined by Statistics Canada
	0=not a member of a visible minority group
Unemployed	1=respondent is unemployed
	0=respondent is not unemployed
Change in economic situation with migration	Scale from -1 to 1 indicating the (self-assessed) change in immigrants' economic situation with migration, where -1 indicates a drastic deterioration and 1 means a drastic improvement.
Canadian citizen	1=respondent is a Canadian citizen
	0=respondent is not a Canadian citizen
Length of residence	Length of residence in Canada in years (1 to 10)
University Education	1=respondent has completed university education
	0=respondent has not completed university education
Age	Age in years
Female	1=respondent is a female
	0=respondent is a male

Tables and Figures

Table 1. Explaining the Gap in Generalized Trust Between Recent Immigrants and Canadian-born Population

	Model 1			Model 2		
	B	**SE**		**B**	**SE**	
Recent immigrants	.59	.11	***	.52	.17	**
Generalized trust in country of origin	3.23	.40	***	3.34	.45	***
Age				.01	.00	
Female				-.05	.12	
Unemployed				.02	.17	
Financial satisfaction				.48	.24	*
Visible minority				-.38	.16	*
City of residence (ref. Montreal)						
Toronto				.00	.14	
Vancouver				.02	.16	
University Education				.79	.13	***
2006 Interview				-.02	.13	
Constant	-1.74	.17	***	-2.50	.31	***
Pseudo R-square	.05			.08		
N	1391			1391		

Entries report Binary logit estimates. *Sources*: WVS and NIS
***: p<.001; **: p<.01; *: p<.05

Table 2. Correlates of Generalized Trust and Trust in Canadians among Recent Immigrants in Canada

	Generalized Trust			Trust in Canadians		
	B	**SE**		**B**	**SE**	
Pre-migration experiences						
Level of generalized trust in country of origin	3.93	.70	***	.99	.90	
Economic situation in country of origin	1.91	.67	**	.65	.89	
Post-migration Canadian experiences						
Treated worse by other Canadians	-.46	.35		.48	.48	
Treated worse by government	-.37	.41		-1.34	.47	**
Visible minority	-.53	.34		-.50	.40	
Unemployed	-.14	.32		.34	.44	
Change in economic situation with migration	1.45	.54	**	1.09	.70	
Canadian citizen	-.11	.33		1.59	.49	**
Length of residence (0-10)	.01	.07		-.20	.09	*
Socio-economic profile						
University education	.40	.28		.16	.37	
Age	.03	.01		.03	.02	
Female	-.10	.23		.13	.30	
Toronto	-.61	.31	*	-.25	.37	
Vancouver	-.62	.31	*	.79	.46	
Constant	-2.91	.64		.03	.83	
Pseudo R-square	.13			.12		
N	388			386		

Entries report Binary logit estimates. *Sources*: WVS and NIS
***: p<.001; **: p<.01; *: p<.05

Table 3. Trust and Immigrant Integration in the Host Country

	Confidence in Political Institutions		Interest in Politics		Satisfaction with democracy		Subjective Health Evaluation		Happiness		Satisfaction with life	
	B	**SE**	**B**	**SE**	**B**	**SE**	**B**	**SE**	**B**	**SE**	**B**	**SE**
Zero order relationships:												
Generalized Trust (0-1)	.56	.26c	-.01	.08	.19	.13	.00	.06	.09	.06	.20	.15
Trust in Canadians (0-1)	1.11	.36b	.25	.11c	.28	.18	.26	.09b	.16	.08c	.48	.20c
First order relationships:												
Generalized Trust (0-1)	.41	.27	-.05	.08	.16	.13	-.04	.06	.07	.06	.14	.15
Trust in Canadians (0-1)	.99	.36b	.26	.11c	.24	.18	.27	.09b	.14	.08*	.44	.21c
N	433		487		476		487		486		487	

Entries report unstandardized OLS regression coefficients.
a: p<.001; b: p<.01; c: p<.05; *: p<.10